ment. Though practical limbs may be a few years away, this field of study is jumping leaps and bounds higher than most areas of research.

Introducing computers in the lives of those without proficient motor skills requires an appropriate interface. Voice input aids with speech recognition systems is one form of PC control available. Using military technology, a system which recognises eye movements is being developed for those with a severe lack of muscle control. A simple glance at an icon and a subsequent blinking of the eye can open folders and execute applications. In a way, this device replaces keyboard strokes with eye movements.

Has technology done enough?

Can technology do it at all? Surely it has been able to aid the lives of millions worldwide and compared to three decades ago, research in the field of Assistive Technology has grown tremendously. But are the visions of human-like limb replacements with skin possible? As far as predictions go, it will be any time from 10 to 100 years before disabilities can be serviced and repaired like an automobile. But for now, the best hope that the disabled across the world have is the progression of stem-cell research. If successful, stem-cell research can lead to various cures for many types of impediments. Some call it the final conquest in the pursuit for a fully enabled world. But this research doesn't go without controversy.

Some would argue that science at large has neglected the needs of the disabled community. However, the truth is that even in the 21st century, relatively little is known about the various afflictions people face. Various aids and devices do help, but they suffer from bulkiness and are expensive. Obviously, the community is looking for something better. How else can all of humanity claim to be the true masters of technology?

Making Web Pages for All

Empowering those with physical impairments is the underlying principle of the Web Accessibility Initiative (WAI). Backed by the World Wide Web Consortium (W3C), WAI purses universal accessibility to the Web. New guidelines set by the WAI suggest:

- Web sites to be easily navigable through the use of either a keyboard, mouse or text commands alone.
- Pop-up windows and frames should be avoided and descriptions of pictures and multimedia need to be embedded within the HTML code.
- Ensure that content is as readable without colour as it is with colour. The same goes for style sheets. With or without them, the content should be clearly visible.
- When using tables, identify row and column headers. For tables with more than two rows/columns, use tags to differentiate header and data cells.

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